

Word family: **peak** / **peaks** / **peaked** / **peaking** / **peak** / **peaky**

Base word: **peak**

Forms: **peaks**, **peaked**, **peaking**

Related forms: **peaked**, **peaky**

Part of speech: **noun** (名詞) / **adjective** (形容詞) / **verb** (動詞)

Your sentence:

> "...the shop loses far more than one seat. It loses turnover during **peak hours**..."

Meaning in this passage

Here, **peak** means **the time when activity, demand, customer numbers, traffic, or use is at its highest level**.

So **peak hours** are the restaurant's busiest hours, when the greatest number of customers are likely to want seats.

繁體中文： **高峰的；最繁忙的；需求 / 活動量達到最高水平的**

中文翻譯：

> "...during **peak hours**..."

「.....在**繁忙高峰時段**.....」

Here:

peak hours = 顧客數量、需求或業務活動達到最高水平的時段

1. **peak** = pointed top of a mountain or hill (山峰) — 山峰；峰頂

This is the central concrete noun meaning.

Practice 1

> "Snow covered the mountain **peak**."

「積雪覆蓋着山**峰**。」

Practice 2

> "They finally reached the **peak** just before sunset."

「他們終於在日落前抵達**峰頂**。」

****peak = 山、丘陵等最高而通常較尖的頂部****

Common:

- * mountain peak
- * snowy peak
- * reach the peak
- * highest peak

2. ****peak = highest point/level of something (最高點) — 頂峰 ; 最高水平****

From the physical mountain image, ****peak**** very commonly means the highest level reached by:

- * prices
- * demand
- * performance
- * popularity
- * activity
- * production
- * temperature
- * power

Practice 3

> “Demand reached a ****peak**** in December.”

「需求在十二月達到****高峰****。」

Practice 4

> “Her popularity was at its ****peak****.”

「她的人氣當時正處於****巔峰****。」

Practice 5

> “Traffic reaches its morning ****peak**** around eight o’clock.”

「交通流量大約在八時達到早上的****高峰****。」

****peak = 某項數值、活動、能力或狀態所達到的最高水平****

This is one of the main modern meanings.

3. **peak** = period of greatest activity/success/intensity (高峰期) — 高峰期 ; 全盛期

Sometimes **peak** refers not merely to a single point but to the period around the highest level.

Practice 6

> “The hotel is busiest at the **peak** of the holiday season.”

「酒店在假期季節的**高峰期**最繁忙。」

Practice 7

> “The singer was at the **peak** of her career.”

「那位歌手當時正處於事業**巔峰**。」

at the peak of something = 處於某段活動、成功、需求或發展最強盛的階段

For strict counting, this belongs to Meaning 2.

4. **peak** = adjective: highest / busiest / greatest (形容詞) — 高峰的 ; 最高的 ; 最繁忙的

This is the exact grammatical use in your passage.

Practice 8 — Original

> “Restaurants need their tables most during **peak hours**.”

「餐廳在**繁忙高峰時段**最需要桌位周轉。」

Practice 9

> “Electricity demand is highest during **peak periods**.”

「用電需求在**高峰時段**最高。」

Practice 10

> “The company hired extra staff for the **peak season**.”

「公司在**旺季 / 高峰季節**聘請額外員工。」

****peak + noun = 該事物處於需求、活動、數量或強度最高的時段 / 水平****

Common:

- * peak hours
- * peak period
- * peak season
- * peak demand
- * peak traffic
- * peak capacity
- * peak performance

5. ****peak performance / peak condition = best possible state (能力) — 巔峰表現；最佳狀態****

Practice 11

> “Athletes try to reach ****peak performance**** during major competitions.”

「運動員會努力在大型比賽期間達到****巔峰表現****。」

Practice 12

> “The machine must operate at ****peak efficiency****.”

「機器必須以****最高效率****運作。」

Here ****peak**** means:

> ****the highest or best achievable level****

This remains under the adjective/highest-level branch.

6. ****peak = verb: reach the highest point/level (動詞) — 達到高峰；見頂****

This is a major verb sense.

Practice 13

> “Sales ****peaked**** in July.”

「銷售額在七月**達到高峰**。」

Practice 14

> “Traffic usually **peaks** around six in the evening.”

「交通流量通常在傍晚六時左右**達到高峰**。」

Practice 15

> “The temperature **peaked at** 35°C.”

「氣溫最高**升至**攝氏 35 度。」

****peak = 上升 / 發展至最高點****

Common:

* peak at

* peak in

* peak during

7. ****peak = reach one's highest level of ability/success (人物) — 達到巔峰****

People, careers, teams, athletes, etc. can also ****peak****.

Practice 16

> “Some athletes ****peak**** in their late twenties.”

「有些運動員在二十多歲後期達到競技****巔峰****。」

Practice 17

> “The band ****peaked**** commercially in the 1990s.”

「這支樂隊在 1990 年代的商業成就達到****頂峰****。」

For strict counting, this is the same verb concept as Meaning 6.

8. ****peak = local maximum on a graph/signal/data series (圖表 / 科學) — 峰值 ; 峰****

In mathematics, science, engineering, medicine, and data analysis, a **peak** is a point where a measured quantity rises to a local or overall maximum.

Practice 18

> “The graph shows a sharp **peak** at noon.”

「圖表顯示中午出現一個明顯的**峰值**。」

Practice 19

> “The signal contains several **peaks**.”

「這個訊號包含幾個**峰值**。」

Common specialist combinations:

- * signal peak
- * spectral peak
- * voltage peak
- * current peak
- * pressure peak
- * temperature peak
- * chromatographic peak

peak = 曲線、訊號或測量結果中明顯高於周圍數值的最高點

This is an important technical realization of Meaning 2.

9. **peak** = maximum instantaneous value (工程 / 物理) — 峰值；最大瞬時值

In electrical engineering and physics:

- > peak voltage
- > peak current
- > peak power

refer to maximum values.

Practice 20

> “The device must withstand the **peak voltage**.”

「該裝置必須能承受**峰值電壓**。」

This stays within the highest-value branch rather than needing a new core meaning.

10. **peak demand / peak load** = maximum system demand (能源 / 系統) — 尖峰需求；**峰值負載**

Practice 21

> “The network needs extra capacity during **peak demand**.”

「網絡在**尖峰需求**期間需要額外容量。」

Practice 22

> “The system is designed to handle the **peak load**.”

「系統的設計可以承受**峰值負載**。」

Again, domain extensions of the adjective sense.

11. **peak** = projecting front part of a cap (英式服飾) — 帽舌；帽簷前端

In British English, the **peak** of a cap is the stiff projecting part at the front that shades the eyes.

Practice 23

> “He pulled down the **peak** of his cap.”

「他把帽子的**帽舌**拉低。」

peak = 帽子前方突出、用來遮陽的硬帽舌

This is a genuinely distinct noun sense.

American English more commonly uses:

> **bill / visor**

depending on context.

12. **peaked cap = 有帽舌的帽子**

Practice 24

> “The officer wore a **peaked cap**.”

「那名人員戴着一頂**有帽舌的制服帽**。」

Here **peaked** means:

> fitted with a peak/visor

This comes from Meaning 11, not from “reached a maximum.”

13. **widow's peak = V-shaped hairline (固定詞組) — 美人尖 ; V 形髮際線**

A **widow's peak** is a V-shaped point in the hairline at the centre of the forehead.

Practice 25

> “He has a noticeable **widow's peak**.”

「他的髮際線有明顯的**美人尖 / V 形髮尖**。」

This derives from the “pointed top/projection” image.

It is a fixed compound, not another core sense.

14. **peaked = looking pale, tired, or ill (形容詞 , 主要美式) — 面色憔悴的 ; 病容的**

There is another adjective **peaked**, traditionally often pronounced differently from the past tense of **peak**, meaning:

> looking pale, weak, tired, or unwell.

Practice 26

> “You look a little **peaked** today.”

「你今天看起來有點**面色憔悴 / 不舒服**。」

This is a genuine lexicalized adjective and is especially associated with North American English.

Importantly:

> **sales peaked**

= 銷售達到高峰

but:

> **he looks peaked**

= 他看起來病懨懨的

These should not be confused.

15. **peaky** = looking slightly ill / weak (主要英式) — 病懨懨的 ; 面色不佳的**

Peaky has a similar meaning in British English.

Practice 27

> “She’s looking a bit **peaky**.”

「她看起來有點**面色不佳 / 不舒服**。」

This is useful for recognition, but it is less central than **peak** itself.

16. **peak** = very bad / unfortunate (英國都市俚語) — 慘的 ; 倒霉的 ; 糟糕的**

In contemporary British youth/urban slang, **peak** can mean:

> bad, unfortunate, harsh, unpleasant.

Example:

> “That’s **peak**.”

≈ 「那真的很**慘 / 很倒霉**。」

This is socially and regionally marked, and should not be used in formal English.

****Database status:**** genuine modern slang; recognition value, but not standard learner core.

Important distinction: ****peak vs summit****

****summit****

usually refers to the highest point of a mountain.

****peak****

can mean:

- * the mountain top itself;
- * an entire pointed mountain;
- * any highest level figuratively.

> mountain peak

> peak demand

You cannot normally use ****summit**** for demand.

Important distinction: ****peak vs top****

****top****

is extremely broad.

****peak****

emphasizes the ****highest point or maximum level****.

> top of the table

> peak of demand

For quantitative change, ****peak**** is much more precise.

Important distinction: ****peak vs apex****

****apex****

means the highest or most pointed part and is more formal/technical.

peak

is common in both literal and figurative use.

- > apex of a triangle
- > peak of a mountain
- > peak performance

Important distinction: **peak vs crest**

crest

often means the top line of:

- * a hill
- * wave
- * ridge

peak

usually suggests a more distinct highest point.

- > crest of a wave
- > mountain peak

Important distinction: **peak vs high**

In your passage:

high hours ❌

is not idiomatic.

peak hours

means the **busiest/highest-demand period**.

Similarly:

- > high demand

= demand is large.

> peak demand

= demand is at its **maximum level**.

Important distinction: **peak vs rush hour**

peak hours

is broad and applies to many industries:

- * restaurants
- * electricity
- * transport
- * internet usage
- * retail

rush hour

normally refers specifically to periods of very heavy commuter traffic.

So:

> restaurant peak hours

but not normally:

> restaurant rush hour

unless used loosely.

Important distinction: **peak vs prime**

peak

emphasizes maximum level.

prime

often means the best or most important period.

- > peak demand
- > in the prime of life

There is overlap in:

- > peak condition
- > prime condition

but the nuances differ.

Important distinction: **peak vs spike**

peak

= a highest point, which may be broad or sustained.

spike

= a sudden, sharp increase, often brief.

A graph may show:

- > a gradual peak

or:

- > a sudden spike

A spike often produces a peak, but not every peak is a spike.

Important distinction: **peak vs plateau**

peak

= maximum point/level.

plateau

= a level that remains relatively stable after rising.

Example:

> Sales peaked in June and then plateaued.

「銷售在六月見頂，之後維持平穩。」

Grammar note: **peak at + value**

> “Demand peaked at 10,000 units.”

= 需求最高達 10,000 件。

Grammar note: **peak in + time period**

> “Sales peaked in December.”

= 銷售額在十二月達到高峰。

Grammar note: **peak during + event/period**

> “Traffic peaks during the evening.”

= 交通流量在傍晚達到高峰。

Grammar note: **at its peak**

A very common noun construction:

> “Demand was at its peak.”

「需求正處於最高峰。」

> “She was at the peak of her career.”

「她正處於事業巔峰。」

Countability note

Mountain/high point

Countable:

- > a peak
- > several peaks

Abstract maximum

Often countable:

- > a peak in demand
- > several peaks in the data

General state

Often appears in fixed singular expressions:

- > at its peak
- > at peak capacity

Family-extension note

The practical family includes:

* **peak**
* **peaks**
* **peaked**
* **peaking**
* **peaky**

But **peaked** needs special treatment because it can represent two quite different things:

- > sales **peaked**
- > = 達到高峰

versus:

- > you look **peaked**
- > = 看起來病懨懨的

Useful constructions/compounds include:

- * peak hours
- * peak season
- * peak demand
- * peak load
- * peak performance
- * peak efficiency
- * at one's peak
- * reach a peak
- * peak at
- * mountain peak
- * widow's peak
- * peaked cap

A broad second-pass audit also reveals modern British slang ****peak = bad/unfortunate****, which should be registered but not confused with standard formal English.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
peak — mountain	山、丘陵等最高而通常較尖的頂部；山峰 / 峰頂
peak — highest point/level	數值、活動、能力、人氣等所達到的最高點 / 高峰
peak — high period	某項活動、需求或成功最強盛的高峰期 / 巔峰期
peak — adjective	需求、活動、數量或能力達到最高水平的；高峰的
peak — verb	上升、發展或表現至最高點；達到高峰 / 見頂
peak — graph/signal	曲線、訊號或測量數據中的峰值 / 最高點
peak — cap, BrE	帽子前方突出的硬帽舌
peaked cap	有帽舌的制服帽 / 帽子
widow's peak	額頭中央呈 V 形的髮際線；美人尖
peaked — ill-looking	面色蒼白、憔悴或看似不舒服的；主要美式
peaky	看起來病懨懨 / 氣色差的；主要英式
peak — slang	英國部分都市俚語：很糟、很慘、倒霉的

For your original sentence

> "...it loses turnover during ****peak hours****..."

The exact meaning is:

****peak hours = 餐廳顧客最多、座位需求最高、原本最有機會賺取營業額的繁忙時段****

So:

> ****during peak hours****

= ****在繁忙高峰時段 / 客流高峰期****

It does **not** merely mean “during busy hours” in a vague sense. **Peak** suggests that activity is at or near its **maximum level**.

For your database, I would count **5 genuinely useful core meanings** for **peak**:

1. **pointed top/summit of a mountain or similar shape**
2. **highest point or level of activity, amount, performance, success, etc.**
3. **adjective — maximum/busiest/highest-demand**
4. **verb — reach the highest point or level**
5. **BrE noun — projecting visor/peak of a cap**

I would merge graph/signal **peaks**, peak demand, peak load, peak performance, and peak season into the general **maximum-level** network; keep **peaked = pale/ill-looking** and **peaky** as lexical family extensions; and register British slang **peak = bad/unfortunate** separately as a marked modern usage rather than part of the standard core.